



A Quick Start Guide to Snapchat

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1. GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1 System Overview

Snapchat is a messaging application that allows users to communicate with multimedia messages commonly known as “snaps.” Snaps can be directed privately to any number of contacts or shared with a selected audience as “Stories” which last a whole day. Companies and other organizations can even advertise content by creating public snaps, which users can find and view using the “Discover” feature.

1.2 Organization of the Manual

The guide consists of three sections: “General Information,” “Getting Started,” and “Using the Application.”

“General Information” explains the general terms of Snapchat, its purpose, and its basic functions.

“Getting Started” explains the installation process, the setup of a personal Snapchat account, and the general layout of the application.

“Using the Application” explains in more detail how to navigate and use Snapchat’s functionalities.

All images of Snapchat’s interface were taken on my Google Pixel 2 XL, which runs the Android operating system. For iOS users, note that Snapchat’s iOS interface should appear very similar. Two images, Figures 2 and 9, were obtained from online sources, whose URLs are displayed prominently.

1.3 System Configuration

Snapchat operates on the Android and iOS operating systems. It is compatible with Android 4.4 and higher versions, and iOS 10.0 and later. The application requires Internet connection for logging in. If allowed by the user, the application can access the device’s photo storage.

1.4 User Access Levels

Users that have registered for a Snapchat account can access the application’s functionalities.

2. GETTING STARTED

2.1 Installation and Logging In

Snapchat is available on the Google Play Store for devices that run the Android mobile operating system, and the App Store for iOS smartphones and tablets. Installation requires a Google account for Android or an Apple ID for iOS.

Locate the Snapchat application on your device and start the application. A screen containing two buttons labeled “Log In” and “Sign Up” should appear, as demonstrated in Figure 1. If you already have a Snapchat account, press “Log In” and supply your username and password. If you do not have a Snapchat account, press “Sign Up” and follow the instructions to create your Snapchat account. You will be asked to create a unique username and password, and provide personal information, including a valid email address, which will be used to verify your account and can be used to reset a lost or forgotten password.

2.2 Application Layout

After you have created your account or have provided existing login credentials, Snapchat will activate your device’s camera and direct you to the camera screen. Figure 2 on the next page shows the basic layout of the application (although many more minute details are not shown), with all the screens labeled 1 through 8. Screen 1 is the camera screen, and the application navigates you to that screen on startup. Screen 2 displays your personal profile, including your username and your unique “Snapcode,” Snapchat’s version of QR codes. Screen 3 lists all your conversation histories with your contacts. Screen 4 shows one particular conversation history. In newer versions of Snapchat, screens 5 (friends’ Stories) and 6 (“Discover”) are combined into one. Screen 7 displays your saved Snaps (known as “Memories”). Screen 8 displays photos from your internal camera storage if you have permitted Snapchat to access that storage.

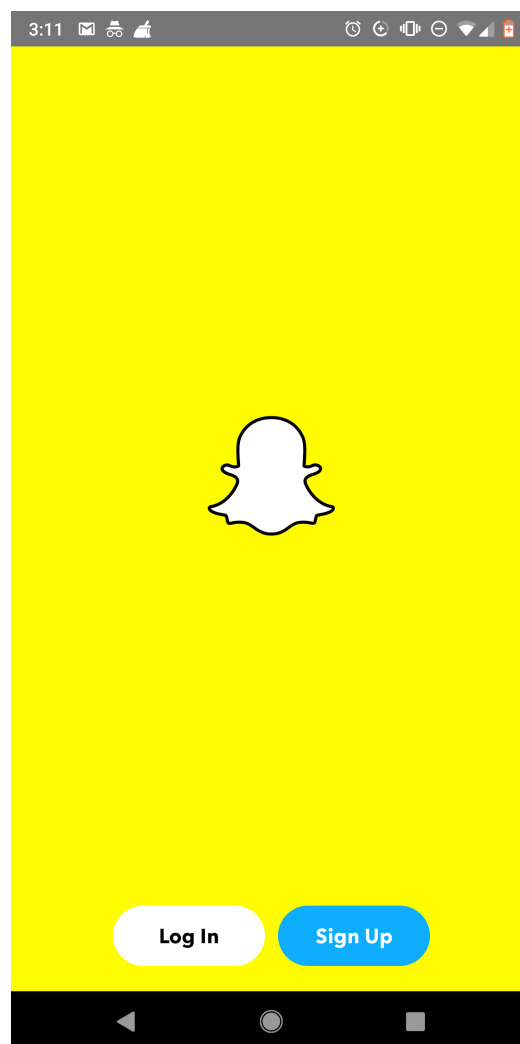


Figure 1: Snapchat opening screen.

Snapchat Map

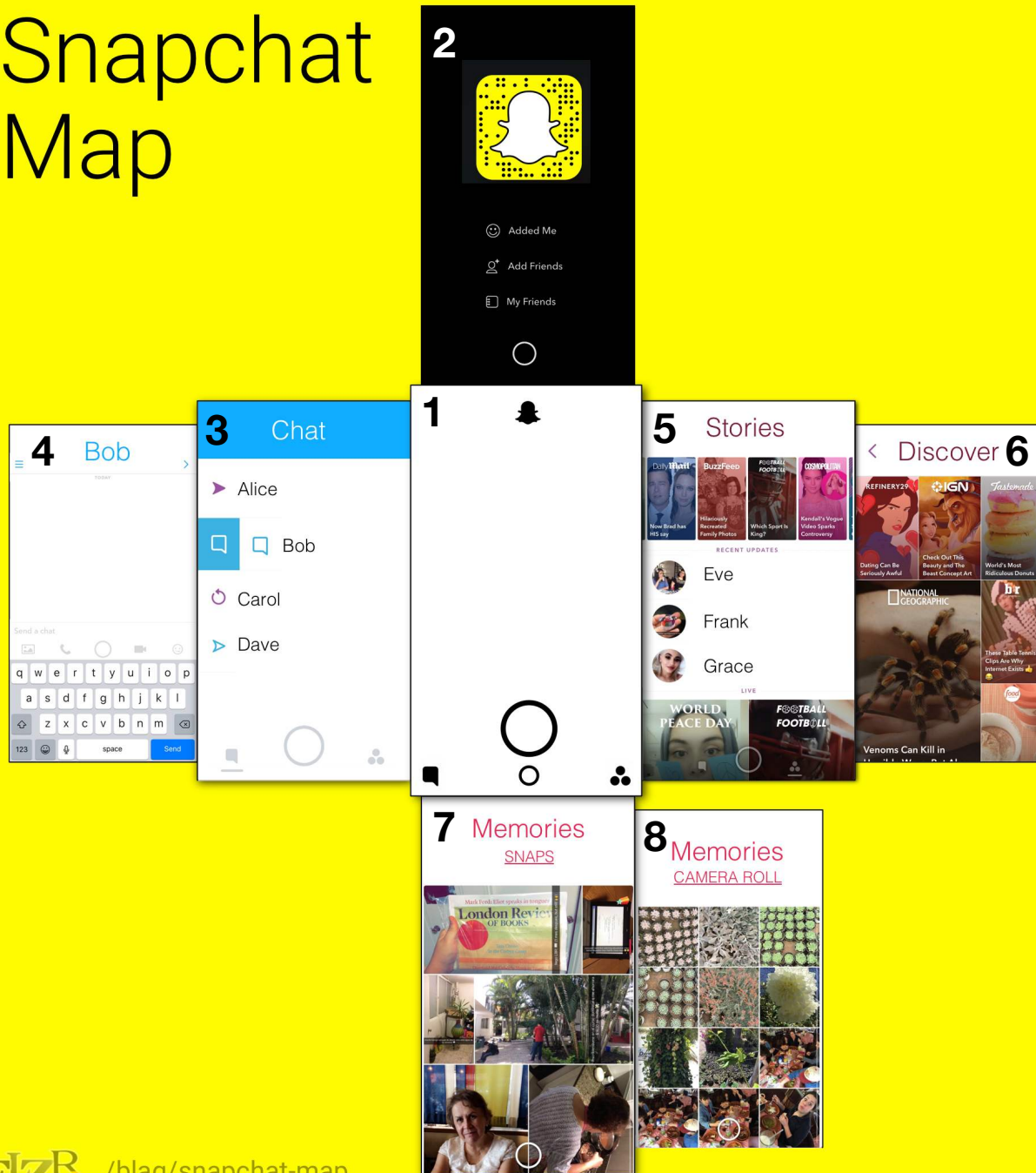


Figure 2: Interface layout of the Snapchat application.

- | | | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|
| 1) Camera | 2) Personal Profile | 3) Conversations | 4) Chat History |
| 5) Friends' Stories | 6) Discover | 7) Saved Snaps | 8) Camera Roll |

To navigate from one screen to another, simply swipe your finger in the direction opposite to the position of the destination screen relative to your current screen. For example, to navigate from the camera screen (Screen 1) to the conversations screen (Screen 3, which is located to the left of Screen 1), swipe right (i.e. hold your finger on the screen and move your finger from left to right).

3. USING THE APPLICATION

3.1 Adding Friends

Snapchat contacts, known as “friends,” are other Snapchat users that you add to your contact list. Snapchat “friendships” are not mutual; whomever you add as a friend must add you back to facilitate the process of sending snaps to each other. Non-mutual friendships involve complications such as the ability to share snaps, and is out of scope of this beginners guide. By default, every Snapchat user has Team Snapchat, an automated Snapchat user, as one of their mutual friends. To add friends, tap your profile icon in the upper-left corner of the camera screen, as indicated by the red circle in Figure 3.

You will now see your profile screen (Screen 2), as shown in Figure 4. As previously mentioned in Section 2.2, Application Layout, the pattern of dots on the yellow square is called a Snapcode. A Snapcode is a unique pattern that corresponds to one user. Snapcodes can be saved into one’s camera storage and can be sent to other people. Scanning a Snapcode with your camera or providing an image containing a Snapcode allows you to add contacts quickly. To add contacts, start by tapping “Add Friends.”

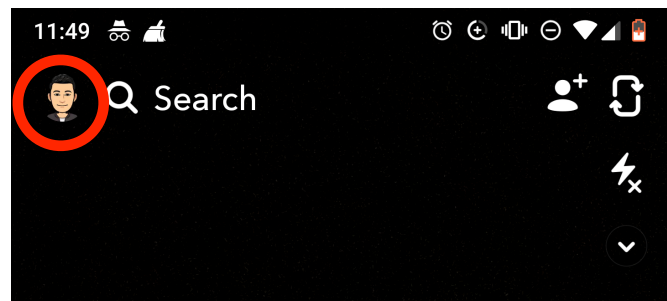


Figure 3: Upper portion of the camera screen (Screen 1). The red circle indicates the profile icon. By default, profile icons are initialized to a solid-colored avatar. The cartoonish avatar in Figure 3 is called a Bitmoji, a customizable avatar that can be configured to resemble or represent you.



Figure 4: Upper portion of the profile screen. Your personal Snapcode and name are displayed at the top.

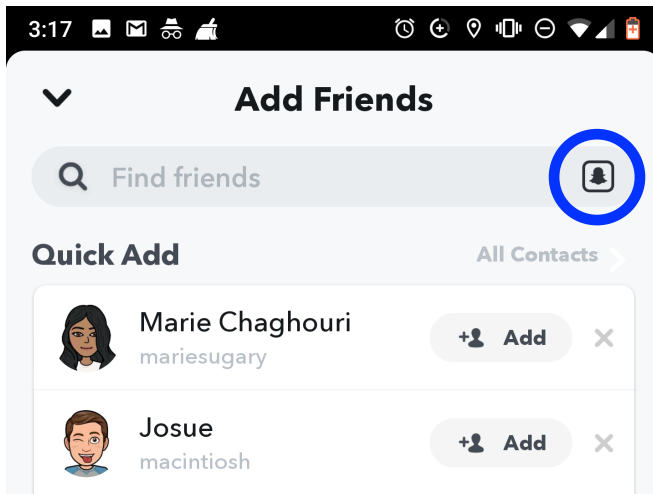


Figure 5: Add Friends. Quick Add displays contacts with whom you share mutual friends. For beginning Snapchat users with no contacts yet, Quick Add will not display anybody.

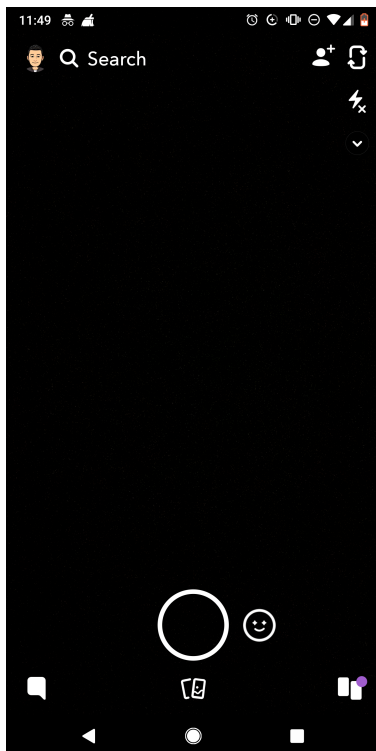


Figure 7: Camera screen.

You will now be navigated to the screen shown in Figure 5: a search box in which to enter the username of your desired contact. Add friends by entering their usernames into the search box and press the “Add” buttons to the right of their names (Figure 6). If you have a photo your desired contact’s Snapcode, press the icon in the blue circle (you may have to grant the app permission to access your camera storage) and select a photo containing a clear image of the Snapcode. If the app successfully scans the Snapcode, the contact will be added.

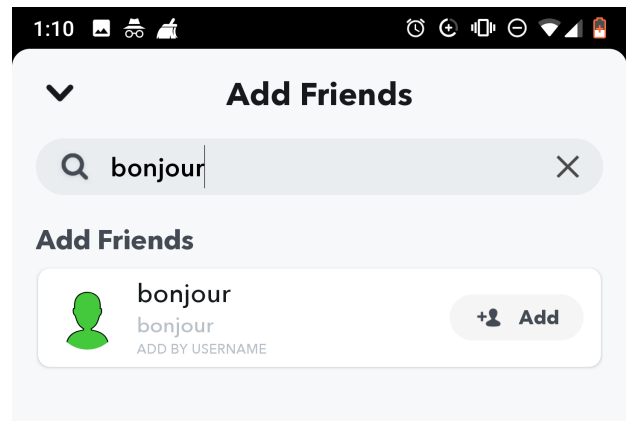


Figure 6: Searching for a user by username.

3.2 Creating and Sharing Snaps

After having added friends, you are now ready to create your first snap. Snaps are multimedia messages that contain text, photos/videos, or a combination of those two. Navigate to the camera screen as shown in Figure 7. The large circle near the bottom of the screen is the capture button. Tap the button to take a photo. Hold the capture button down to record a video. Videos recorded using Snapchat are segmented into ten-second intervals. The series of images below demonstrate the process of experimenting with filters and various tools to customize and embellish the snap. Filters use face detection and apply a special effect to a person’s face. Doodling tools are also available for the user to make simple digital drawings. Text can be added, as well.

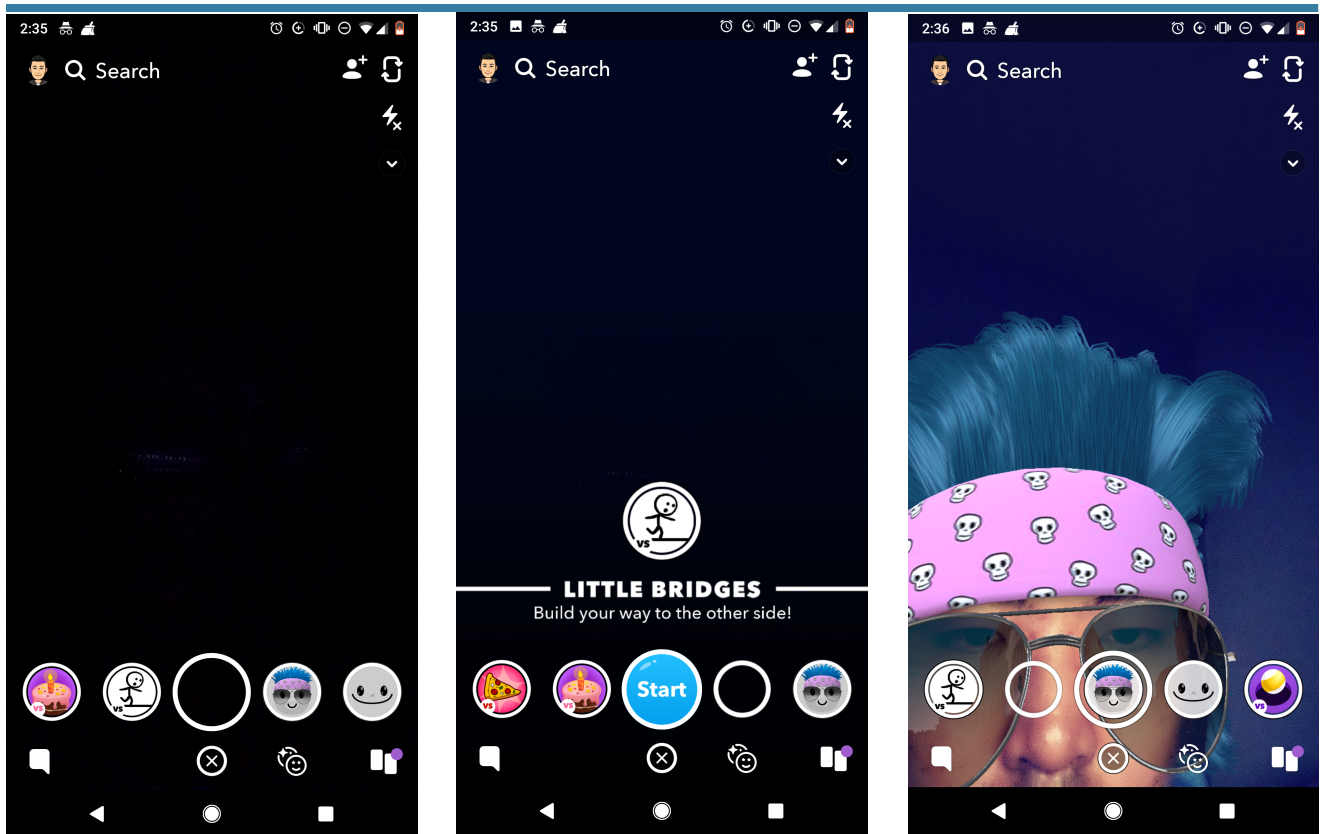


Figure 8: The process of creating a snap and directing it to a select contact(s). The upper middle and upper right images show the user experimenting with different filters. The lower left image shows the user adding text. The final two images show the user sending the snaps to the desired contacts.

